

NIGERIA — WEEKLY THREAT BRIEF

Nigerian Military Counter-Insurgency Operating Environment

Prepared for: rotary-wing air support & UAV / small-aircraft ISR team

Reporting period: 18 – 24 August 2026 (6 days) | Issued: Monday 24 August 2026. The North East stayed quiet on the ground — no new base assault since Mandaragirau (15 August) — but the AIR war was the loudest in weeks: four reported OPHK strike engagements between 18 and 22 August claiming roughly 46+ fighters killed. The week's two biggest ground events were outside the North East: the Bin-Per reprisal massacre in Plateau (18 August, 23–24 killed) and a Lakurawa mass attack with mass abductions in Borgu LGA, Niger State (21 August) that pulls the threat map toward Kainji. Background from the baseline assessment and earlier issues is not repeated.

1. Bottom Line Up Front

- **The NE ground pause held, but OPHK air platforms had their busiest reported week in months — four strike engagements, ~46+ claimed killed, all military/Zagazola-sourced.** 18 Aug ~21:56: a Guardian aircraft cued a precision strike on eight fighters lying in wait at Thethangala in the Timbuktu Triangle (all assessed killed). 21 Aug: strikes at Aduwa (Guzamala LGA) destroyed two ISWAP gun trucks; survivors were tracked towing a damaged vehicle toward Gudumbali/Lake Chad. Night 21–22 Aug: an armed-reconnaissance platform over Aduwa struck a concentration (~16 assessed killed), re-attacked a regrouped remnant at midnight (~10), while a second platform struck ~12 at a hut near Buratai at 00:31. Claims are unverified and BDA is sensor-based, but the pattern — persistent armed ISR, multi-platform night work, re-attack of squirts — is the strongest demonstration yet of the RPA-cued strike posture this brief has been tracking.
- **The enemy answer this week was route interdiction, not base assault: three MSR incidents in four days, twice at bridges.** 18 Aug: troops detonated an IED on the Dikwa–Ajiri–Maiduguri MSR (between Bakassi and Bale Junction) that was covered by terrorist fire, and a second device before the Hot Sama bridge on the New Marte–Dikwa route. 21 Aug 10:21: fighters on motorcycles shot up a trailer truck on the Gajiram–Mairari MSR before FOB Gajiram pickets drove them off. With Mandaragirau's counter-QRF bridge IED last week, that is now four bridge/MSR devices in ten days — the argument for air resupply, air QRF and air CASEVAC over road movement keeps strengthening, and bridges remain the predictable chokepoints.
- **Lakurawa mounted a mass attack in Borgu LGA, Niger State on 21 August — hundreds of fighters, killings and mass abductions toward the Kainji Lake forests. Multi-source (AFP/Reuters).** Fighters stormed Dikera and Binzi villages after Friday prayers, killing residents accused of not following their teachings and marching abductees — reportedly including a chief imam and a village head — into the forests toward Kainji Lake. A rival faction (Mahmuda/Mamudawa) intervened mid-attack and fought Lakurawa, letting some residents escape. This is the week's most significant threat-geography shift: an IS-Sahel-linked group operating in strength on the Niger–Kebbi–Kwara–Benin seam, in the AOR of the new 29 Brigade (Kainji) and 9 Division (Ilorin). Niger State goes 3 → 4 on the heatmap.
- **Plateau produced the week's worst massacre: Bin-Per, Kombun District, Mangu — 23–24 killed in a reprisal, 48 hours after the Jwak Maitumbi attack it answered.** Suspected Fulani militia infiltrated from the Bokokos axis in the early hours of 18 August and went house to house; troops recovered 16 bodies, community and councillor counts reached 23–24, and 38 houses were burnt (multi-source: Zagazola, Vanguard, Sahara Reporters). It is the reciprocal-cycle mechanism this brief flagged last week, now at massacre scale. Air-relevant: OPEP and the NAF flew a show-of-force to secure Jos church services on 23 August — the air component is now directly tasked in Middle Belt reassurance, and Mangu–Bokokos infiltration routes are a live ISR target set.

- **Force-protection streak intact — no enemy drones, no MANPADS/AAA, no GPS/EW interference, no aircraft or UAV losses; roughly twelve weeks.** The information fight is heating instead: the Army moved this week against an AI-driven defamation campaign (fabricated obituaries and misconduct claims against the COAS, the NDA Commandant and the Director of Army Public Relations), a week after DHQ's X-account breach warning. Treat unusual official-channel output — including any loss or shoot-down claim — as unverified until confirmed through the chain; a false June claim that a NAF helicopter was downed near Zungeru shows the template. Meanwhile parents of the Mussa and Lassa abductees protested in Uba on 20 August as the Mussa cohort passed ~100 days in captivity; no proof-of-life this window.

2. North East Developments

Window note: six-day window, quiet on the ground and loud in the air. No new base assault after Mandaragirau (15 August), no new friendly-loss ambush, and no repetition of the ISWAP–JAS factional fighting reported around Bama last week (that chain remains single-source and unverified). The operative read: after three FOB assaults in August were repelled, ISWAP has shifted this week's observable effort to MSR interdiction while OPHK air platforms work its concentrations.

The air-interdiction cluster, 18–22 August

- **Thethangala, Timbuktu Triangle — 18 Aug, ~21:56.** A Guardian aircraft established overhead and sighted eight fighters converged and lying in wait, assessed as preparing an attack on troops in the area; a precision strike was authorised and BDA assessed all eight killed with no further movement. The 'lying in wait' framing matters: this was interdiction of an ambush before it happened, the clearest example yet of the ISR-cued pre-emption cycle.
- **Aduwa, Guzamala LGA — 21 Aug.** OPHK air platforms destroyed two ISWAP gun trucks (one completely burnt) and inflicted casualties; surviving fighters were observed towing another damaged vehicle and evacuating wounded around Gudumbali, moving toward Lake Chad. Casualty figures not established; senior-commander identities 'being verified'.
- **Aduwa and Buratai night strikes — 21/22 Aug.** An armed-reconnaissance platform over Aduwa (22:23) tracked fighters to a settlement and struck the largest group (~16 assessed killed in and around makeshift structures); at about midnight it re-attacked ~10 who had fled and regrouped under a tree (all assessed killed). A separate platform tracked ~12 fighters to a hut near Buratai and struck at 00:31 (~12 assessed killed). Combined claim ~38 for the night, ~46+ for the window. All single-chain military sourcing; treat numbers as claims. Note Buratai sits on the Biu axis — the same general area as the Mandaragirau assault — so the strikes bracket both the Lake Chad and southern-Borno concentrations.

MSR interdiction and the logistics squeeze

The 18 August IED pair (Dikwa–Ajiri–Maiduguri MSR between Bakassi and Bale Junction — covered by fire, meaning an ambush initiation, not just a leave-behind; and New Marte–Dikwa before the Hot Sama bridge) plus the 21 August Gajiram–Mairari truck shooting mark a deliberate turn against the road network. In the same window troops arrested five suspected terrorist logistics suppliers in Borno, and in Zamfara (see Section 4) intercepted three disassembled canoes procured by a kingpin to move supplies — the counter-logistics fight is running in both directions.

Surrender flow accelerating

DHQ reports 47 terrorist family members (women and children) surrendered in Borno between 16 and 20 August, citing hunger, insecurity and factional clashes inside the enclaves; six fighters surrendered in Kukawa LGA in the same period; ten women and 24 children fled an enclave and surrendered on 21 August; and seven family members with 12 children fled the Yaganari enclave

separately. Zagazola claims surrenders are up over 250% in a month — an unverifiable figure, but the direction is corroborated by the DHQ numbers and is consistent with strike pressure plus the ISWAP–JAS factional war degrading enclave life. Watch for the flow to surface intelligence on the school abductees.

Schools thread — day 56 and ~day 101, unresolved

Parents of the abducted Mussa primary-school pupils (taken 15 May) and the Lassa Government Day Secondary School students (36 students and one staff member, taken 29 June, Askira/Uba LGA) protested in Uba town on 20 August demanding federal action — the Mussa cohort is now past 100 days. Reuters photographed the protest; no release, negotiation or proof-of-life reporting surfaced this window. Also rescued this week: a woman and two children held since 2017 (last week's item), and a 63-year-old Cameroonian national taken on the Gwoza–Cameroon axis, recovered in Dikwa LGA on 17 August.

3. Air / ISR & Force-Protection Watch Items

- **Deconfliction: assume multiple armed RPAs airborne simultaneously, working two axes at once.** The 21/22 August night showed at least two precision platforms operating concurrently — one over Aduwa/Guzamala (north, Lake Chad approaches), one over Buratai (south, Biu axis) — plus the standing Sambisa coverage. Verify ROZ activation, altitude blocks and the strike-clearance chain over the Timbuktu Triangle, the Guzamala–Gudumbali corridor and the Biu/Buratai axis before every launch. Strikes are being re-attacked at the same point minutes apart (the midnight Aduwa re-strike), so do not assume a struck target area is cold.
- **The MSR/bridge pattern is a rotary-wing tasking signal.** Four IED/ambush events on MSRs in ten days — two at or short of bridges (Hot Sama; Mandaragirau–Kana) and one covered by fire — argue for air resupply and air CASEVAC into contested FOBs and for treating bridge approaches as observed. Route-scanning support (picketing overwatch, pattern-of-life on bridge chokepoints) is likely to be requested more often; the Gajiram FOB reaction on 21 August shows pickets engaging within minutes, so coordinate low-level transits near MSRs with the ground scheme to avoid masking friendly fires.
- **Middle Belt: the air component is now visibly tasked — Jos show-of-force, 23 August.** OPEP with the NAF, NSCDC and other agencies flew/conducted a show-of-force to secure Sunday church services in Jos after Bin-Per. Expect recurring reassurance tasking over Mangu–Bokkos and Jos, and ISR value in the infiltration corridors between the Bokkos axis and Kombun District — attackers moved on foot through isolated routes, exactly the signature persistent ISR is good at.
- **Western corridor watch: Lakurawa at Kainji changes the map.** If tasked toward the Niger–Kebbi–Kwara seam, note the command picture is new: 29 Brigade (Kainji) and 9 Division (Ilorin, Op SAVANNAH SHIELD — active this week with a kill at Alabe Idera, Ifelodun and seven victims recovered at Patigi) stood up in July and the Borgu attack is their first mass-casualty test. Kainji hosts NAF assets and was the launch area for earlier joint operations; abductees were reportedly moved into the Kainji Lake forests, a plausible future ISR tasking.
- **Threat systems: still nothing — twelve weeks.** No enemy drone use, no MANPADS/AAA, no GPS/EW interference and no aircraft or UAV losses reported this window. The last documented armed-drone use against a Nigerian base remains Sabon Gari, Damboa (late January 2026); the last confirmed airframe loss the 2 January CH-4 (technical, Kontagora). The standing caution is unchanged and sharpens with every strike week like this one: ISWAP's incentive to answer RPA-cued losses with its own unmanned systems is rising, and the first appearance should be reported immediately, not filed as interference.

- **Information integrity is now a named front: AI-driven defamation of the chain of command.** The Army moved this week to counter a campaign by a discharged ex-soldier publishing AI-generated content — including fabricated obituary announcements portraying senior officers as deceased — against the COAS Lt Gen Waidi Shaibu, NDA Commandant Maj Gen Oluyemi Olatoye and Director of Army Public Relations Col Apollonia Anele. Paired with the 15 August DHQ X-account breach attempt and June's false Zungeru helicopter shoot-down claim, the pattern is clear: expect fabricated loss/casualty claims involving air assets, and verify through the chain before reacting or repeating.
- **US dimension — nothing new; posture assumption updated.** No new US strike or AFRICOM announcements this window. Reporting indicates most deployed US forces withdrew in early July after the May–June joint operations, with intelligence support continuing at Nigeria's request. Practical read: US kinetic activity is dormant but US ISR presence remains possible — keep it in the deconfliction picture rather than assuming an empty sky.

4. Other Theatres in Brief

- **North West — steady-severe; logistics interdiction wins.** DHQ reports 28 abduction victims recovered 17–19 August across Bukkuyum (Zamfara), Sabuwa and Kankara (Katsina) and Isa (Sokoto). In Zamfara, troops intercepted three disassembled canoes procured by kingpin Shehu Bagewaye to move supplies across waterways (23 August), arrested a courier moving 180 units of explosives on the Kaura–Zurmi road, and picked up a second supply-chain suspect in Gusau. In Kaduna, police rescued 75 kidnapped travellers in Birnin Gwari (21 August) — one of the largest single recoveries this year — while kidnappers in Sanga LGA killed two locals and abducted a doctor and a district head's wife (23 August). A police inspector was killed in a herder ambush on a joint team in Gwaram, Jigawa (23 August). No release reporting yet for the Kasuwar Daji (1 August) or Unguwar Rogo captives.
- **North Central / Middle Belt — Bin-Per dominates; both directions of the cycle visible again.** Beyond Bin-Per (Section 1): a man was killed at an illegal mining site in Barkin Ladi (23 August); OPEP troops separately recovered cattle rustled by Berom militia in Quan'pan and intervened after farm destruction and the assault of a herder in Barkin Ladi — the reciprocal pattern in miniature. Comd OPEP Maj Gen Dangana publicly pressed the Mwaghavul Youth Movement to abandon revenge attacks and misinformation. Elsewhere: OPWS rescued 13 abductees on the Alloma–Ejule road axis (Kogi); troops killed a gang leader during an attempted kidnap at Assakio (Nasarawa) and a terrorist at Kyado, Ukum (Benue); a Kogi joint patrol rescued a victim after a gun battle (24 August); three died in a clash between two Fulani families in Takum, Taraba (23 August); and an arms courier was arrested in Taraba with a hideout cache recovered in Jalingo.
- **South East — the quiet broke: two lethal camp raids in eight days, and an IED killed a security operative.** 15 Bde (JTF SE / Op UDO KA) with DSS and vigilantes dismantled three IPOB/ESN camps in Anambra on 15 August, killing three; a joint team raid at Amiyi, Ogbaru LGA on 22 August killed six suspected secessionists — and a security operative died when a planted IED detonated. Troops cleared 11 IEDs advancing on the 'Mother Valley' complex in Ihiala (20 August) and disarmed more on the Odumeje–Eketutu–Udah axis in Imo. IPOB called the raids staged distractions from the Nnamdi Kanu case. With the November Anambra governorship approaching, security tempo there will rise. Anambra goes 2 → 3 on the heatmap; note the IED density if tasked to support UDO KA.
- **Niger Delta / Gulf of Guinea — eleventh consecutive quiet week for militancy; enforcement tempo up.** No new pipeline or maritime attack claims. Op DELTA SENTINEL disrupted three illegal refining sites in the Egbema axis (Rivers), recovering ~85,000 litres of stolen/refined product; DELTA SAFE made kidnap and arms-trafficking arrests in Delta; and the Navy announced an intensified anti-piracy/oil-theft offensive from Calabar (21 August).

- **Political weather — the 2027 defection wave rolls on; Mawlud holiday Tuesday.** Ogun's governor received hundreds of PDP/ADC defectors into the APC (22 August); ex-Adamawa governor Bindow re-registered with the APC (23 August); Governor Adeleke's camp denied an APC-defection rumour. The Federal Government declared Tuesday 25 August a public holiday for Eid-el-Mawlud — expect large congregations and processions in northern cities, a standing soft-target concern for the day.

5. Country Activity Heatmap (last 3 months)

The two views below summarise assessed security activity across all 36 states and the FCT over roughly the last three months ($\approx$ late May – 24 August 2026). The choropleth shows each state's dominant incident type (fill colour) and intensity (shade depth and number); the matrix breaks activity down by incident type. This is an indicative qualitative assessment for orientation — synthesised from open-source reporting, not a counted event dataset such as ACLED. THREE level changes this issue: Niger 3 $\rightarrow$ 4 with dominant type shifting banditry $\rightarrow$ terrorism (the 21 August Lakurawa mass attack and mass abduction in Borgu LGA); Kwara 1 $\rightarrow$ 2 (Savannah Shield contact at Ifelodun, Patigi recoveries, Lakurawa spillover risk from Borgu/Kainji); Anambra 2 $\rightarrow$ 3 (two lethal camp raids, an operative killed by IED, 11 IEDs cleared at Ihiala). Borno holds 4 — reinforced by the week's strike cluster and MSR IEDs. Plateau holds 4, heavily reinforced by Bin-Per; Benue holds 4 on a quieter week; Zamfara, Katsina and Sokoto hold 4; Kaduna holds 3 (Birnin Gwari 75-victim rescue, Sanga abductions); Kebbi and Kogi hold 3; Jigawa holds 1 with a communal marker added (Gwaram ambush); Delta holds 2; Osun holds 1.

Nigeria Activity Heatmap — Geographic View (assessed, last ~3 months)
Indicative qualitative assessment as of 2026-08-24 — not a counted incident dataset

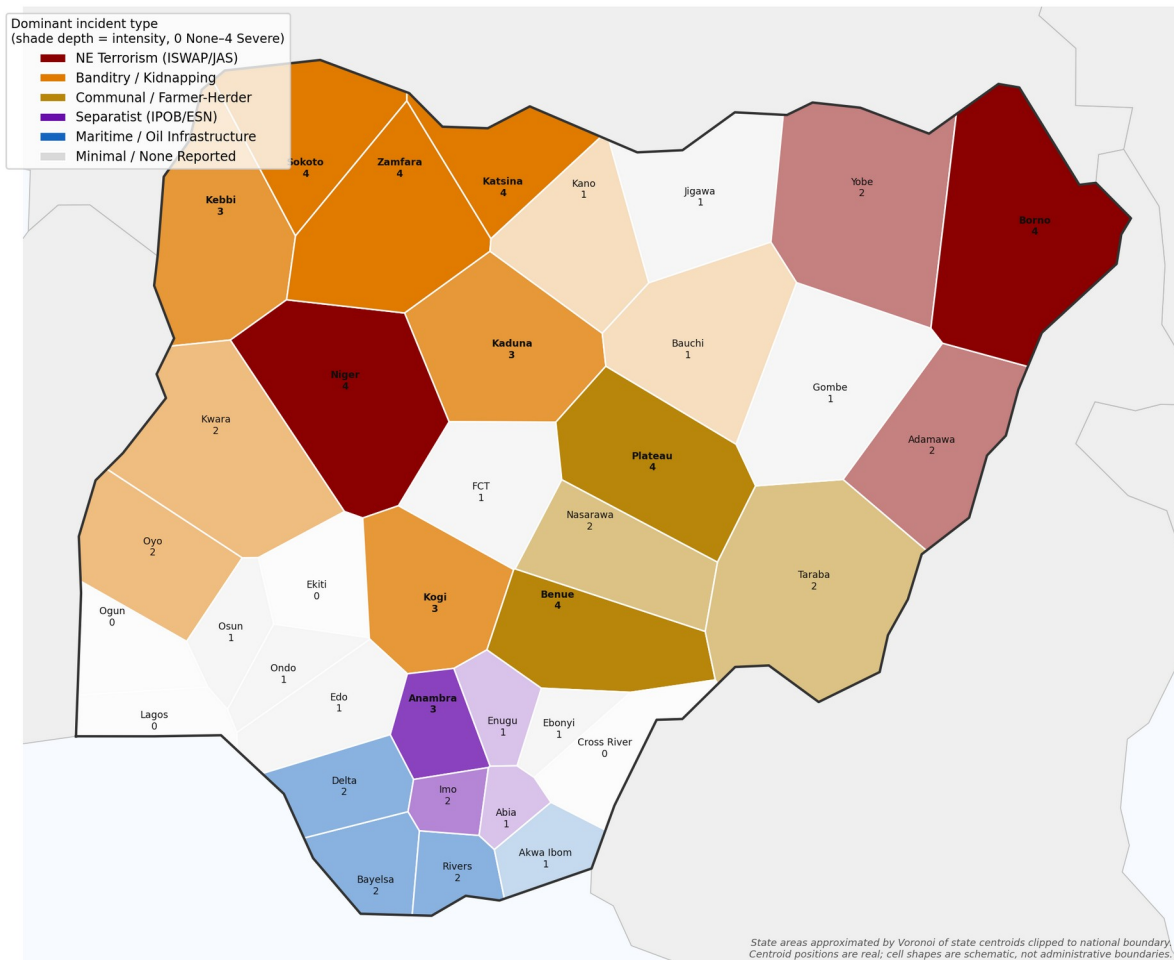


Figure 1 — Activity choropleth on a Natural Earth basemap (Nigeria + neighbours). Fill = dominant incident type; shade depth & number = intensity (0 None–4 Severe). State areas are approximated by Voronoi of state centroids clipped to the national boundary — centroid positions are real, cell shapes schematic. Indicative qualitative assessment, not a counted dataset.

Nigeria Activity Heatmap — Incident Type by State (assessed, last ~3 months)
States grouped by geopolitical zone — indicative qualitative assessment as of 2026-08-24, not a counted dataset

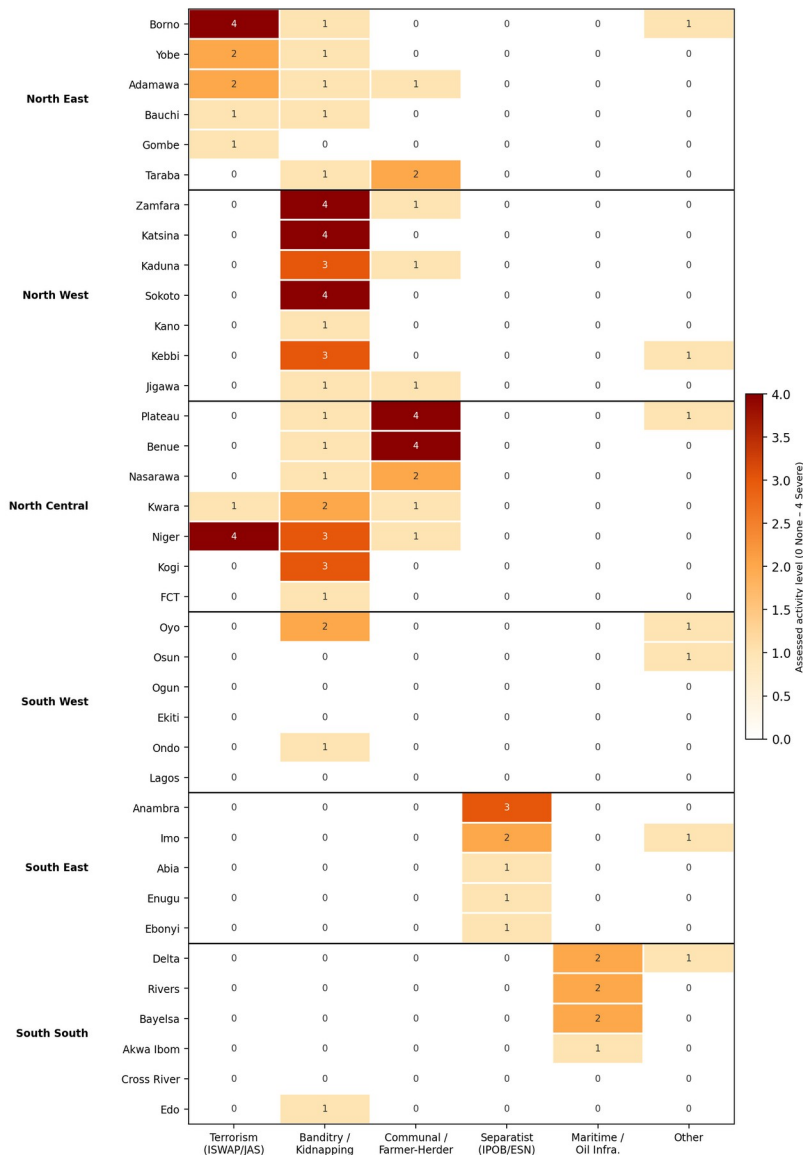


Figure 2 — Incident type by state (states grouped by geopolitical zone). Cell value/shade = assessed activity level, 0 None–4 Severe. Indicative qualitative assessment, not a counted dataset.

6. Events Map — UCDP (curated) & GDELT (news-derived)

Two-panel figure from this morning's scheduled daily map run (24 August; GDELT ingested through 23 August). GOOD NEWS ON THE LEFT PANEL: a new UCDP release has landed — the most recent seven days of curated data are now 25–31 July 2026 (29 events, ~174 best-estimate fatalities, 57 civilian), cutting the lag from ~7 weeks to ~3½. That late-July window includes the Katsina Guga/Bakori mass attack and the heavy NE air-interdiction period, so the left panel now usefully backstops recent issues of this brief — but it still pre-dates the current window; read it as verified pattern, not this week's ground truth. Right panel: news-derived GDELT events for the actual last seven days (17–23 August 2026: 447 machine-coded events from ~3,973 articles, deduplicated and cross-checked against UCDP). GDELT is timely but noisy — locations and event types are machine-extracted and individual dots are not verified incidents. Cross-referenced against

Sections 1–4, expect clusters over the Biu/Buratai and Guzamala/Aduwa axes (strike coverage), Mangu–Bokkos (Bin-Per), Borgu LGA in western Niger State (the Lakurawa attack — a new signature well west of the usual mass), Birnin Gwari (the 75-victim rescue) and Anambra (camp raids). Read the panels together: UCDP for verified pattern, GDELT for current tempo and geography.

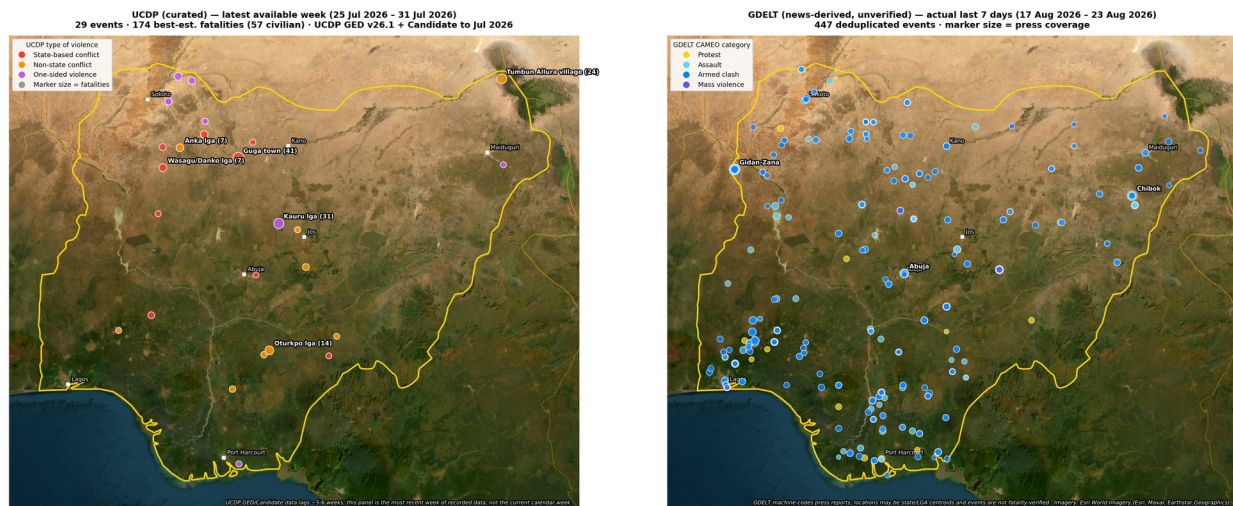


Figure 3 — Left: UCDP-recorded conflict events, most recent 7 days of available curated data (25–31 July 2026; lags ~3½ weeks — NOT current-week ground truth). Right: GDELT news-derived events for 17–23 August 2026 — machine-coded from press reporting, deduplicated, unverified; indicative of current reporting tempo only. Rendered 24 August 2026 from the daily-updated Nigeria Events Map.

Interactive map: <https://rbmglobal.github.io/nigeria-events-map/>

7. Sources

Open-source reporting consulted 24 August 2026. Military and government figures are flagged as claims throughout. Two-source or better this window: the Bin-Per massacre (Zagazola, Vanguard, Sahara Reporters, Chronicle — independent community/clergy chains), the Borgu Lakurawa attack (AFP survivor and lawmaker interviews, carried by Daily Sabah and others; Reuters photo coverage of related events), the Mussa/Lassa parents' protest (Reuters via US News, Sowetan, Tribune), the Anambra raids (Sahara Reporters, Vanguard, P.M. News), and the DHQ weekly operations summary (official, via PRNigeria). Effectively single-chain (Zagazola security-sources) and unverified: ALL of the week's air-strike claims and BDA figures (Thethangala, Aduwa, Buratai), the MSR IED pair, the Gajiram–Mairari truck attack, the canoe interception and most Plateau/Kogi/Taraba minor items. Date-verification note: four recirculated items surfaced in this week's searches and were excluded — the Jilli market accidental airstrike (April 2026), the Mussa school attack itself (May 2026 — though its ~100-day anniversary protest IS current), the Kebbi Dadinkowa mosque attack (February 2026) and the Taraba Bandawa–Fulani '40 dead' crisis (May 2025).

North East & air campaign

- [Operation HADIN KAI Neutralise ISWAP Fighters in Precision Airstrike in Timbuktu Triangle \(19 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Thethangala, 18 Aug 21:56; Guardian aircraft; 8 assessed killed)
- [OPERATION HADIN KAI AIR STRIKES DESTROY ISWAP GUN TRUCKS, KILL FIGHTERS IN ADUWA \(23 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (21 Aug, Guzamala LGA; 2 gun trucks; survivors toward Gudumbali/Lake Chad)
- [Operation HADIN KAI Air Platforms Eliminate 38 Terrorists in Devastating Multiple Precision Strikes Across Borno \(22 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (night 21/22 Aug; Aduwa ~16 + ~10 re-attack; Buratai ~12; claims)

- [Troops Detonate Two IEDs Along Maiduguri-Dikwa, Marte Routes \(19 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (18 Aug; Bakassi–Bale Junction, IED covered by fire; Hot Sama bridge)
- [Troops Foil Terrorist Attack on Truck Along Gajiram-Mairari Road \(23 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (21 Aug 10:21; FOB Gajiram pickets; MSR small-arms attack)
- [Troops Arrest Five Suspected Terrorist Logistics Suppliers in Borno](#) — Zagazola (counter-logistics thread)
- [Seven ISWAP Fighters' Family Members, 12 Children Flee Yaganari Enclave, Surrender to Troops](#) — Zagazola (surrender flow)
- [10 Women, 24 Children Flee Terrorist Enclave, Surrender to Troops in Borno \(21 Aug 2026\)](#) — PRNigeria
- [Families protest in Nigeria over children abducted nearly 100 days ago \(21 Aug 2026\)](#) — Reuters via US News (Uba protest, 20 Aug; Mussa 15 May & Lassa 29 Jun cohorts)

Official weekly summary

- [Nationwide Operations: Troops Rescue 48 Abductees, Neutralise Terrorists, Bust Criminal Networks \(22 Aug 2026\)](#) — DHQ via PRNigeria (14–20 Aug: 47 family surrenders Borno; 28 rescued NW; 13 rescued Kogi; Savannah Shield Kwara; UDO KA IED clearances; Delta Sentinel 85,000L)

Niger State / Lakurawa & North West

- [Terrorists kill, kidnap worshippers during Friday prayers in Nigeria \(22 Aug 2026\)](#) — AFP (Dikera & Binzi, Borgu LGA, 21 Aug; hundreds of Lakurawa fighters; Mahmuda intervention; abductees toward Kainji Lake)
- [Troops Intercept Three Canoes Procured by Terrorist Kingpin, Disrupt Logistics Plan in Zamfara \(23 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Shehu Bagewaye)
- [Kaduna Police Rescue 75 Kidnapped Travellers in Birnin Gwari \(21 Aug 2026\)](#) — PRNigeria
- [Kidnappers Kill Two Locals, Abduct Doctor and Hakimi's Wife in Kaduna \(23 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Sanga LGA)
- [Police Inspector Killed, Another Injured in Herdsmen Ambush in Jigawa \(23 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Gwaram LGA)

Middle Belt

- [Suspected Fulani Bandits Kill 23 in Major Reprisal Attack on Bin-Per Community in Plateau \(18 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (16 bodies recovered by troops; councillor/MYM count 23–24; Jwak Maitumbi reprisal context)
- ['Gunmen went from house to house, killing people who were sleeping' — Survivors of Plateau night of horror \(Aug 2026\)](#) — Vanguard (survivor accounts; 38 houses burnt)
- [Reverend Dachomo Calls For Help After Gunmen Sacked Mangu Christian Community In Plateau, Leaving 23 Dead \(22 Aug 2026\)](#) — Sahara Reporters (independent clergy chain)
- [Operation Enduring Peace Conducts Show of Force, Secures Church Services in Jos \(23 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (OPEP + NAF + NSCDC)
- [OPEP Commander Moves to End Revenge Killings, Misinformation in Mangu \(23 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Maj Gen W. M. Dangana, Comd OPEP)
- [OPEP Troops Recover Cattle Rustled by Berom Militia, Return Livestock to Owners in Plateau \(23 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (reciprocal-cycle evidence)

South East & information integrity

- [Anambra Bloodbath: Six secessionists killed as security operative dies in explosion \(23 Aug 2026\)](#) — P.M. News (Amiyi, Ogbaru LGA, 22 Aug; IED killed operative)

- [Nigerian Troops Raid Alleged ESN Camps In Anambra, Kill Three Persons, Arrest Three Others \(15 Aug 2026\)](#) — *Sahara Reporters (15 Bde, JTF SE / Op UDO KA)*
- [IPOB Accuses Nigerian Army Of Staging 'Fake' ESN Camp Raids To Divert Attention From Nnamdi Kanu \(16 Aug 2026\)](#) — *Sahara Reporters (IPOB counter-narrative)*
- [Nigerian Army Moves to Halt AI-Driven Defamation Campaign Against Senior Officers \(22 Aug 2026\)](#) — *PRNigeria (fabricated obituaries, AI multimedia; COAS/NDA Commandant targeted)*
- [No evidence terrorists shot down NAF Helicopters in Niger State \(fact-check\)](#) — *Legit.ng (June Zungeru shoot-down claim debunked — template for fabricated loss claims)*

Political & standing references

- [Abiodun receives hundreds of PDP, ADC defectors into APC, mobilises Ogun East for 2027 \(22 Aug 2026\)](#) — *Vanguard*
- [Adeleke's Camp Reacts to APC Defection Rumour \(Aug 2026\)](#) — *Legit.ng (rumour denied)*
- [U.S. Africa Command press releases \(standing reference\)](#) — *AFRICOM (no new Nigeria strike announcements in window)*

Annex A — State Governors, Ethnic Affiliation & Principal Army Formations

Standing annex — changes since the 18 August issue are summarised here. NO GUBERNATORIAL CHANGE this issue: an Adeleke (Osun) defection-to-APC rumour was denied by his camp; the 2027 defection wave continued at sub-gubernatorial level (Ogun mass defections 22 Aug; ex-Adamawa governor Bindow re-registered APC 23 Aug). THREE FORMATION-COLUMN UPDATES: (1) Plateau — reporting now consistently designates the Plateau AOR operation as Op ENDURING PEACE (OPEP), Comd Maj Gen W. M. Dangana, working alongside the state-level Op Rainbow; treat 'Op Safe Haven' as superseded in current reporting. (2) Anambra — a newly established 15 Brigade under JTF South East / Op UDO KA led this week's camp raids; added to the Anambra row. (3) Niger/Kwara — the new 29 Bde (Kainji) and 9 Div (Ilorin, Op Savannah Shield) are now operationally in play following the Borgu Lakurawa attack; WATCH markers added. The July 2026 force-structure changes (9 Div Ilorin, 10 Div Jalingo, 5 Div Makurdi, reorganised 2 Div Ibadan; brigades at Gboko, Kainji, Lafia) remain in transition — expect ambiguity over which HQ owns a given ground picture or airspace request in the Middle Belt / North Central. Caveats unchanged: ethnic affiliations are as commonly stated in public reporting — several are contested or simplified, and 'Hausa/Fulani' reflects the common compound identification in the far north. Military entries are an indicative open-source ORBAT (division/brigade home locations and operation AORs), not a current disposition — task-force deployments move constantly; verify against your unit's own theatre picture.

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
NORTH EAST				
Borno	Babagana Umara Zulum	APC	Kanuri	HQ 7 Div & OPHK Theatre Comd (Maiduguri); multiple task-force bdes on the Monguno/Dikwa/Gwoza/Bama axes; MNJTF Sector 3 (Baga); NAF air component OPHK (Maiduguri)
Yobe	Mai Mala Buni	APC	Kanuri	OPHK Sector 2 (Damaturu); task-force brigade elements (Buni Yadi axis)

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
Adamawa	Ahmadu Umaru Fintiri	APC (defected from PDP, Feb 2026)	Northern-Adamawa minority (Madagali axis); identification varies in public reporting	23 Bde (Yola)
Bauchi	Bala Mohammed	PDP (opposition)	Fulani	33 Artillery Bde (Shadawanka Barracks, Bauchi)
Gombe	Muhammadu Inuwa Yahaya	APC	Fulani	Rear-area/support elements to OPHK
Taraba	Agbu Kefas	APC (defection from PDP announced for Jan 2026)	Jukun	HQ 10 Div (Jalingo) — activated Jul 2026, GOC Maj Gen C. R. Nnebeife; 6 Bde (Jalingo); Op Whirl Stroke elements
NORTH WEST				
Kaduna	Uba Sani	APC	Hausa/Fulani	HQ 1 Div (Kaduna); Nigerian Defence Academy; major NAF bases (Kaduna)
Kano	Abba Kabir Yusuf	APC (defected from NNPP, 26 Jan 2026)	Hausa/Fulani	3 Bde (Kano)
Katsina	Dikko Umaru Radda	APC	Fulani	17 Bde (Katsina) — Op Fansan Yamma
Kebbi	Nasir Idris	APC	Fulani (Kauran Gwandu)	Elements under 8 Div AOR (Birnin Kebbi garrison)
Sokoto	Ahmed Aliyu	APC	Hausa/Fulani	HQ 8 Div (Sokoto) — Op Fansan Yamma
Zamfara	Dauda Lawal	APC (defected from PDP, Mar 2026)	Hausa	1 Bde (Gusau); OPFY Sector 2
Jigawa	Umar Namadi	APC	Hausa/Fulani	Elements under 3 Bde (Kano) AOR
NORTH CENTRAL				
Plateau	Caleb Mutfwang	APC (defected from PDP, late 2025)	Mwaghavul	HQ 3 Armoured Div (Jos); UPDATED: Op ENDURING PEACE (OPEP) — Comd Maj Gen W. M. Dangana; reporting now consistently uses OPEP for the Plateau AOR (vice Op Safe Haven); state-level Op Rainbow alongside
Benue	Hyacinth Alia	APC	Tiv	HQ 5 Div (Makurdi) — GOC Maj Gen Moses Gara, dual-hatted Comd Op Whirl Stroke (Jul 2026); 11 Bde (Gboko); 72 Special Forces Bn (Makurdi); NAF Tactical Air Command HQ (Makurdi)
Niger	Mohammed Umaru Bago	APC	Nupe	31 Artillery Bde (Minna); Army TRADOC (Minna); 29 Bde (Kainji) — WATCH: Lakurawa mass attack in Borgu LGA 21 Aug puts the new Kainji brigade's AOR in play
Kwara	AbdulRahman AbdulRazaq	APC	Yoruba (Ilorin)	HQ 9 Div (Ilorin) — GOC Maj Gen Yakubu Yahaya, dual-hatted Comd Op Savannah Shield (Jul 2026), visibly active this week (Ifelodun kill, Patigi rescues); Sobi Barracks

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
				garrison
Kogi	Ahmed Usman Ododo	APC	Ebira	Garrison elements (Lokoja); confluence-axis security ops; joint ops under 2 Div AOR (western Kogi)
Nasarawa	Abdullahi Sule	APC	Hausa	10 Bde (Lafia); Op Whirl Stroke elements (Lafia axis)
FCT Abuja	— (administered by FCT Minister Nyesom Wike)	APC-aligned (Wike ex-PDP)	Ikwerre (minister)	Guards Bde (Abuja); Defence HQ & Service HQs; NAF HQ
SOUTH EAST				
Abia	Alex Otti	Labour Party (opposition)	Igbo	14 Bde (Ohafia)
Anambra	Charles Soludo (re-elected Nov 2025)	APGA (opposition, APC-aligned)	Igbo	302 Artillery Regt (Onitsha); NEW: 15 Bde — newly established under JTF South East / Op UDO KA, led this week's camp raids
Ebonyi	Francis Nwifuru	APC	Igbo	Elements under 82 Div AOR (Abakaliki)
Enugu	Peter Mbah	APC (defected from PDP)	Igbo	HQ 82 Composite Div (Enugu)
Imo	Hope Uzodinma	APC	Igbo	34 Artillery Bde (Obinze, Owerri)
SOUTH SOUTH				
Rivers	Siminalayi Fubara (reinstated Sep 2025 after emergency rule)	APC (reported defection from PDP, Dec 2025)	Ijaw (Opobo/Nkoro)	HQ 6 Div (Port Harcourt); JTF Op Delta Safe; NNS Pathfinder
Bayelsa	Douye Diri	APC (defected from PDP, 2025)	Ijaw	16 Bde (Yenagoa)
Delta	Sheriff Oborewori	APC (defected from PDP, May 2025)	Okpe (Urhobo)	63 Bde (Asaba); Op Delta Safe elements
Edo	Monday Okpebholo (elected Sep 2024)	APC	Esan	4 Bde (Benin City)
Akwa Ibom	Umo Eno	APC (defected from PDP, 2025)	Ibibio	2 Bde (Uyo)
Cross River	Bassey Otu	APC	Efik	13 Bde (Calabar); Navy Eastern Command (Calabar) — anti-piracy/oil-theft offensive announced 21 Aug
SOUTH WEST				
Lagos	Babajide Sanwo-Olu	APC	Yoruba	HQ 81 Div (Lagos); Navy Western Command
Ogun	Dapo Abiodun	APC	Yoruba	Elements under 81 Div AOR
Oyo	Seyi Makinde	PDP (opposition)	Yoruba	HQ 2 Div (Ibadan) — GOC Maj Gen Auwalu Mahmuda (Jul 2026)
Osun	Ademola Adeleke (re-elected 15 Aug 2026 — second term)	Accord Party — left PDP Dec 2025; won with 511,067 votes vs APC 444,815. His camp DENIED an APC-defection rumour this week	Yoruba	Elements under 2 Div AOR
Ondo	Lucky Aiyedatiwa (elected Nov 2024)	APC	Yoruba (Ilaje)	32 Artillery Bde (Akure/Owena)
Ekiti	Biodun Oyebanji	APC	Yoruba	Elements under 2 Div

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
				AOR (Ado-Ekiti garrison)

Changes to watch: the western corridor is the new item — 29 Bde (Kainji) and 9 Div (Ilorin) face their first mass-casualty test after Borgu, and any air support west of Minna will run through a headquarters that stood up eight weeks ago; confirm the supported HQ and comms plan rather than assuming the 8 Div picture. The OPEP designation change matters for Plateau tasking paperwork. Politics: defection tempo is accelerating ahead of 2027 (Ogun, Bindow this week; Kano and Zamfara earlier this year); a Rivers relapse (Fubara–Wike tension) and Osun election-petition litigation remain the flagged watch items. Formation notes most relevant to the air mission: 7 Div / OPHK (Maiduguri) remains the supported command in the North East; 8 Div (Sokoto) and 1 Div (Kaduna) run the North West under Op Fansan Yamma; 3 Armoured Div (Jos) runs OPEP; NAF Tactical Air Command HQ is Makurdi, co-located with the new 5 Div HQ.

Reminder: This is open-source orientation only and is not a substitute for current in-theatre intelligence. Verify all specifics against your unit's authoritative reporting before acting on them operationally.